The Art Engagement Reflection Scale (AERS)

This scale is intended to measure the process of cognitive engagement carried out during art viewing.

Factors reflect three levels of engagement, *Early, Automatic Processing*, *Intermediate, Memory-Based Processing*, and *Meaning Making and Final Judgement*, described by the Mirror Model of Art (Tinio, 2013). These factors can be combined to form a higher-order factor, *Depth of Engagement*.

For administration, the administrator is encouraged to use the scale modularly to fit their needs. For example, a researcher can elect to use qualitative and quantitative items from only one level of the scale, or they may wish to use the quantitative or qualitative item sets alone, foregoing a mixed-methods approach.

This early release version of the scale is unpublished. Please reach out to Rebekah Rodriguez-Boerwinkle at rebekah.rodriguez-boerwinkle@yale.edu for questions about the scale or up-to-date citation information.

Level 1: Early, Automatic Processing

Quantitative (Likert items):

"Please rate the extent to which you agree with the following statements based on your initial reaction to the artwork."

"I was immediately drawn to specific visual details in the artwork (e.g., colors, shapes, textures)."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

"Certain elements of the artwork stood out to me as soon as I looked at it."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

"I noticed the fine details of the artwork quickly."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

"The textures or patterns in the artwork caught my eye right away."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

Qualitative (Open-ended question):

"Describe the specific visual elements (e.g., colors, textures, shapes) that first caught your attention. What was it about them that stood out to you?"

Level 2: Intermediate, Memory-Based Processing

Quantitative (Likert items):

"Please rate the extent to which you agree with the following statements based on your reflections after observing the artwork for a few moments."

"The artwork reminded me of a past experience or memory."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

"As I looked at the artwork, I found myself making connections with other things I've seen or learned."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

"Over time, my understanding of the artwork deepened."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

"I found myself reflecting on how the artwork relates to my personal experiences."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

Qualitative (Open-ended question):

"What specific memories, prior knowledge, or personal experiences came to mind as you viewed this artwork? How did they influence your understanding of the art?"

Level 3: Meaning Making and Final Judgement

Quantitative (Likert items):

"Please rate the extent to which you agree with the following statements based on your final thoughts and feelings about the artwork."

"The artwork conveyed meaningful themes or ideas to me."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

"I experienced strong emotions while viewing the artwork."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

"My overall impression of the artwork changed as I thought more about it."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

"The artwork made me reflect on deeper concepts or questions."

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree)

Qualitative (Open-ended question):

"What broader themes, ideas, or emotions did the artwork evoke for you? How did your interpretation of the artwork evolve as you spent more time with it?"